

1. About Junicode

Junicode is modeled on the Pica Roman type purchased by Oxford University in 1692 and used to set the bulk of the Latin text of George Hickes, *Linguarum vett. septentrionalium thesaurus grammatico-criticus et archaeologicus* (Oxford, 1703–5). This massive two-volume folio is not only a major work of scholarship on the languages and literatures of northern Europe in the Middle Ages, but also a fine example of the work of the Oxford Press at this period: printed in multiple types (for every language had to have its proper type) and lavishly illustrated with engravings of manuscript pages, coins and artifacts.

Junicode also includes two other typefaces from the *Thesaurus*: Pica Saxon, used to set passages in the Old English language, and a typeface reproducing the Gothic alphabet (“Gothic” here being not the late medieval style, but rather the earliest extensively attested Germanic language). These were commissioned by the literary scholar Franciscus Junius (1591–1677) and bequeathed by him to the University. Examples of all these typefaces can be found in *A Specimen of the Several Sorts of Letter Given to the University by Dr. John Fell, Sometime Lord Bishop of Oxford. To Which Is Added the*